

Conversation

#02

CONVERSATION

THE ROBBERY

Teacher's note: Get 6 pieces of paper, number them 1 to 6 and have each student draw one to see which character they will be.

The Victim's flat has been broken into and a new IBM Notebook is found to be missing. The Victim, the Janitor, Neighbor 1 and Neighbor 2 must decide who is to blame: Suspect 1 or Suspect 2 (who, on the other hand, must prove their innocence).

1. Victim: You live alone in flat 203. You left home for work at 06:45 a.m. and upon returning home at 7:35 p.m., found the front door open. Neighbors 1 and 2 were standing in the hallway. You notice that your new IBM Notebook is missing. The flat is a mess: books are scattered on the floor; there are clothes all over the bedroom floor; the bathtub is full of water (the water is moving in small waves, as if someone had just been bathing); you also notice a slip of paper with your name and address on it. "Whoever it was must still be in the building," you think. You rush downstairs to talk to the doorman and find out who had just left the building.

2. Janitor: You arrived for work at 8:00 a.m. and started mopping the hallways. At 5:00 p.m. you had finished all the mopping and cleaning and went to flat 203 to clean it. While you were in flat 203, through a window you saw Suspect 1 walking past the building. Suspect 1 was looking directly to the window you were going to start cleaning. Upon noticing that someone was at the window, Suspect 1 turned away and started walking fast. When you left the building at 7:30 p.m. Suspect 1 was seen drinking beer in a bar on the corner by the building. You noticed that Suspect 1's hair was wet.

3. Neighbor 1: You are an elderly person who lives in flat 202. You heard noises coming from flat 203 at around 7:00 p.m. and thought that the Victim might have arrived earlier that day. You heard the noise of water flowing in the bathtub and found that strange because the Victim never uses the bathtub, just the shower. The noise of someone bathing went on for a long time and you found that even stranger because the Victim is known to be a very thrifty person and wouldn't let water be running for that long. Anyway, you, who are very curious, decided to have a closer look at what was happening in flat 203. There is a bathroom window to the hallway and you decided to go there and try to call the Victim, to see if there was anything wrong. While getting dressed to go to the hallway you noticed that the sound of someone bathing had stopped but now the noise of things being thrown about could be heard. "Fair enough, as I am halfway dressed I'll go there and knock on the door. There is something fishy here," you think. As you opened the front door someone walked past the door hurriedly. You could only see the shadow of someone, who dropped a notebook battery on the floor and rushed down the stairs, and Neighbor 2 standing at the door of flat 202, which is opposite the stairway.

4. Neighbor 2: You live in flat 204. You heard noises coming from flat 203 at around 7:00 p.m. You also thought the Victim might have arrived earlier that day. You never heard the noise of water flowing, as the bathroom window is not near flat 204 but you did hear the noise of things being thrown about. You found that strange, because you know that the Victim is a very quiet, reserved person. Curiosity led you to the front door. You stood in the hallway, by the front door for quite a while and finally saw someone leave flat 203 hurriedly, drop a notebook battery on the floor and run the opposite way, towards the stairway. At almost the same time Neighbor 1 came out of flat 202.

5. Suspect 1: You are unemployed, and according to you, to drown your sorrows, you had been drinking since 10 a.m. in a bar on the corner by the building. You got drunk in late afternoon, went to the toilet in the bar and had a quick shower — that explains your wet hair. The new IBM notebook on the chair has a battery, but it's not a genuine IBM. You are supposed to owe the Victim a grudge.

6. Suspect 2: You are unemployed, too. You claim you were trying to sell the new IBM Notebook to make ends meet. Your hair is not wet but the notebook is lacking a battery. You supposedly have a grudge against the Victim.

COMPOSITION

Write about a crime in which you or someone you know was the victim. Give as many details as possible.

Full name: _____

Theme: _____

Title: _____
